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THE MISSISSIPPI CHALLENGE

The future of the United States of America may well be determined here, in Mississippi, for it is here that Democracy faces its most serious challenge. Can we have government in Mississippi which represents all of the people? This is the question that must be answered in the affirmative if these United States are to continue to give moral leadership to the Free World.

JUNE 21, 1964
On the eve of the "Freedom Summer" campaign in Mississippi, three civil rights workers are reported missing after their arrest in Philadelphia, Mississippi

JULY 16
King asserts that nomination of Senator Barry Goldwater by Republicans will aid racists

JULY 20
Arrives in Mississippi to assist civil rights effort

AUGUST 4
The bodies of missing civil rights workers are discovered

AUGUST 22
Testifies at Democratic convention on behalf of Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party

In 1964 the meaning of so-called Negro revolution became clear for all to see and was given legislative recognition in the civil rights law. Yet, immediately following the passage of this law, a series of events shook the nation, compelling the grim realization that the revolution would continue inexorably until total slavery had been replaced by total freedom.

The new events to which I refer were: the Republican Convention held in San Francisco; the hideous triple lynchings in Mississippi; and the outbreak of riots in several Northern cities.